Probability

Experimental

i.e. Dealing with collected data.

Chp1: Data

Methods of sampling, types of data, and populations vs samples.

Chp2: Measures of Location/Spread

Statistics used to summarise data, including mean, standard deviation, quartiles, percentiles. Use of linear interpolation for estimating medians/quartiles.

Chp3: Representation of Data

Producing and interpreting visual representations of data, including box plots and histograms.

Chp4: Correlation

Measuring how related two variables are, and using linear regression to predict values.

Theoretical

Deal with probabilities and modelling to make inferences about what we 'expect' to see or make predictions, often using this to reason about/contrast with experimentally collected data.

Chp5: Probability

Venn Diagrams, mutually exclusive + independent events, tree diagrams.

Chp6: Statistical Distributions

Common distributions used to easily find probabilities under certain modelling conditions, e.g. binomial distribution.

Chp7: Hypothesis Testing

Determining how likely observed data would have happened 'by chance', and making subsequent deductions.

This chapter is a recap of the concepts you learnt at GCSE.

1: Basic Probability

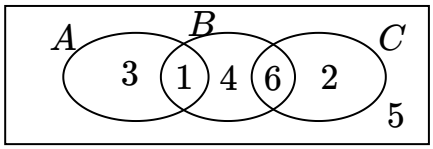
"I throw two fair die. Calculate the probability the sum of the two dice is more than 6."

2: Venn Diagrams

"Out of 50 students, 12 play both piano and drums, 30 play piano and 25 play drums. Find the probability a randomly chosen student plays neither instrument."

3: Mutually Exclusive/Independent Events

Determine whether A and B are independent.



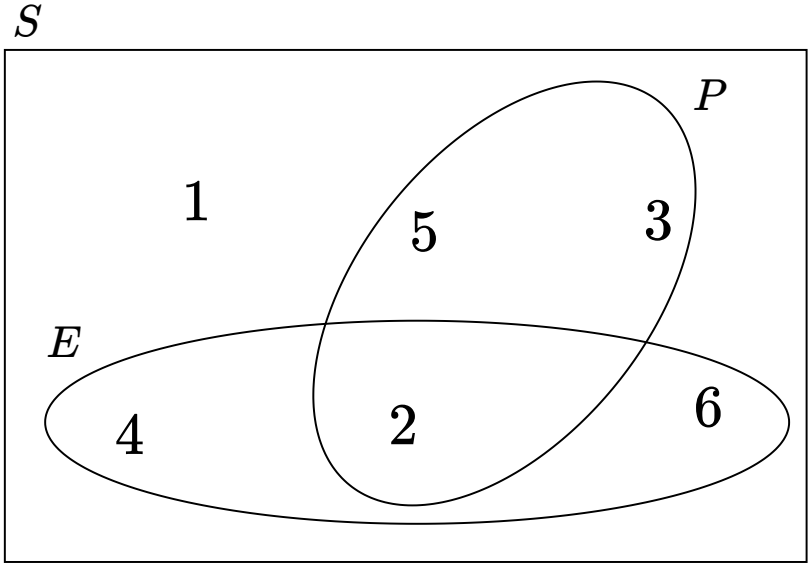
4: Tree Diagrams

"The probability I hit a target is 0.3. If I hit it, the probability I hit again on the next shot is 0.4. If I miss, the probability I hit on the next shot is 0.1. If I shoot 3 times, what's the probability I hit on the first and third shot?"



An **experiment** is a repeatable process that gives rise a number a number of **outcomes**.

An **event** is a set of one or more of these outcomes.
(We often use capital letters to represent them)



E = "rolling an even number"
P = "rolling a prime number"

A **sample space** is the set of all possible outcomes.

Because we are dealing with sets, we can use a **Venn diagram**, where
- the numbers are the individual outcomes,
- the sample space is a rectangle and
- the events are sets, each a subset of the sample space.

You do not need to use set notation like $\cap$ and $\cup$ in this module (but ordinarily you would!)

Example 5

Two fair spinners each have four sectors numbered 1 to 4. The two spinners are spun together and the sum of the numbers indicated on each spinner is recorded.
Find the probability of the spinners indicating a sum of
(a) exactly 5 (b) more than 5

Spinner 2 \ Spinner 1	1	2	3	4
1	2	3	4	5
2	3	4	5	6
3	4	5	6	7
4	5	6	7	8

If the sample space is the amalgamation of two underlying experiments, a table is a helpful way to list the outcomes.

$P(5) = \frac{?}{4}$

$P(>5) = \frac{6}{10} = \frac{3}{?}$

Another Example 6

The table shows the times taken, in minutes, for a group of students to complete a number puzzle.

Time, t (min)	$5 \leq t < 7$	$7 \leq t < 9$	$9 \leq t < 11$	$11 \leq t < 13$	$13 \leq t < 15$
Frequency	6	13	12	5	4

A student is chosen at random. Find the probability for a group of students to complete a number puzzle
(a) In under 9 minutes (b) in over 10.5 minutes.

$P(t < 9) = \frac{?}{}$

$P(t > 10.5) = \frac{?}{}$

3 The masses of 140 adult Bullmastiffs are recorded in a table.

Mass, m (kg)	Frequency
$45 \leqslant m < 48$	17
$48 \leqslant m < 51$	25
$51 \leqslant m < 54$	42
$54 \leqslant m < 57$	33
$57 \leqslant m < 60$	21
$60 \leqslant m < 63$	2

One dog is chosen at random.

a Find the probability that the dog has a mass of 54 kg or more.

b Find the probability that the dog has a mass between 48 kg and 57 kg.

The probability that a Rottweiler chosen at random has a mass under 53 kg is 0.54.

c Is it more or less likely that a Bullmastiff chosen at random has a mass under 53 kg? State one assumption that you have made in making your decision.

a?

b?

c?

4 The lengths, in cm, of 240 koalas are recorded in a table.

Length, l (cm)	Frequency (male)	Frequency (female)
$65 \leqslant l < 70$	4	14
$70 \leqslant l < 75$	20	15
$75 \leqslant l < 80$	24	32
$80 \leqslant l < 85$	47	27
$85 \leqslant l < 90$	31	26

One koala is chosen at random.

a Find the probability that the koala is female.

b Find the probability that the koala is less than 80 cm long.

c Find the probability that the koala is a male between 75 cm and 85 cm long.

Koalas under 72 cm long are called juvenile.

d Estimate the probability that a koala chosen at random is juvenile. State one assumption you have made in making your estimate.

a?

b?

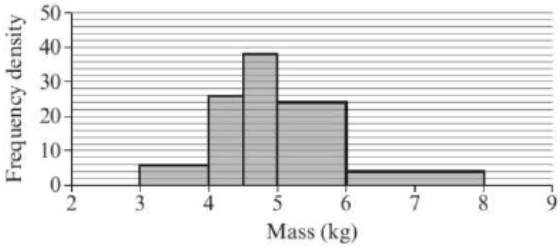
c?

d?

5 The histogram shows the distribution of masses, in kg, of 70 adult cats.

a Find the probability that a cat chosen at random has a mass more than 5 kg. **(2 marks)**

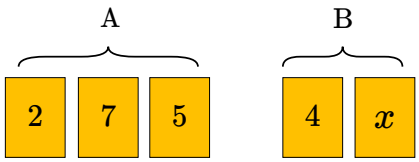
b Estimate the probability that a cat chosen at random has a mass less than 6.5 kg. **(3 marks)**



a?

b?

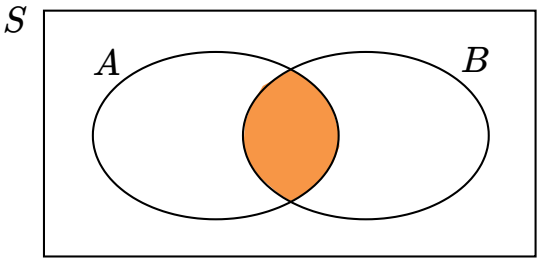
[Challenge p72] Samira picks one card at random from group A and one card at random from Group B.
She records the product, Y, of the two cards as the result of her experiment. Given that x is an integer and that $\mathrm{P}\left(Yiseven\right) = \mathrm{P}(Y \geq 20)$, find the possible values of x.



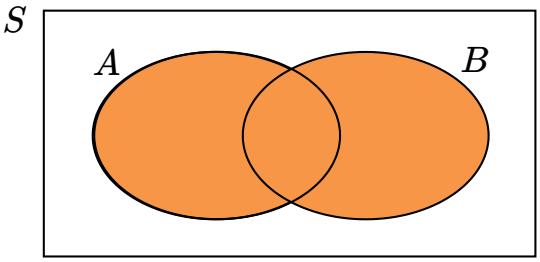
?

Venn Diagrams 11

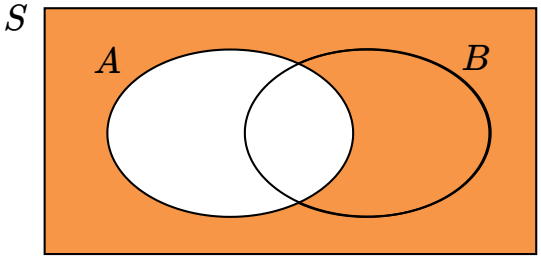
Venn Diagrams allow us to combine events, e.g. "A happened **and** B happened".



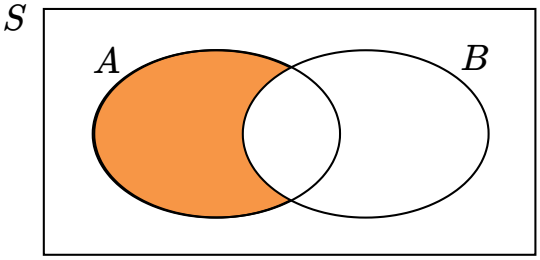
The event "A **and** B"
Known as the **intersection** of A and B.



The event "A **or** B"
Known as the **union** of A and B.



The event "not A"
Known as the **union** of A and B.



These can be combined,
e.g. "A and not B".

Example involving probabilities 12

We can either put frequencies or probabilities into the Venn Diagram.

Given that $P(A) = 0.6$ and $P(AorB) = 0.85$, find the probability of:
a) $P(notAandB)$
b) $P(neitherAnorB)$

?

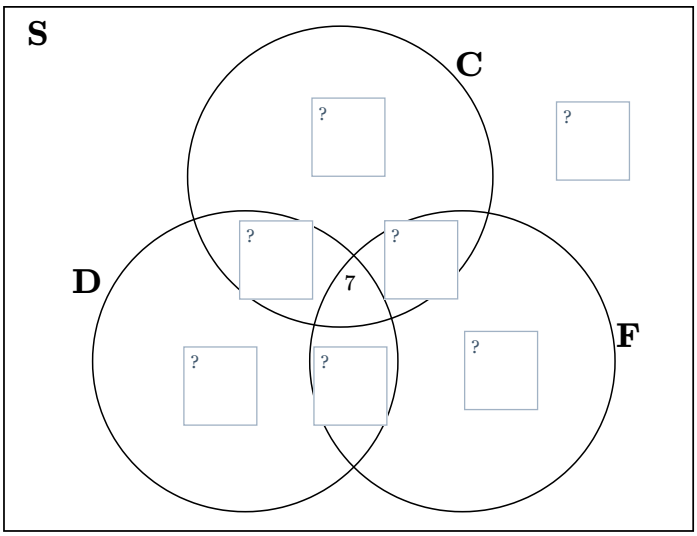
A vet surveys 100 of her clients. She finds that
25 own dogs, 15 own dogs and cats, 11 own dogs and tropical fish, 53 own cats, 10 own cats and tropical fish, 7 own dogs, cats and tropical fish, 40 own tropical fish.

Fill in this Venn Diagram, and hence answer the following questions:

a) $P\left(ownsdogonly\right)$

b) $P\left(doesnotowntropicalfish\right)$

c) $P(doesnotowndogs,\ \ cats, ortropicalfish)$



Tip: Start from the centre frequency and work your way outwards using subtraction.

a) $\frac{(}{1}$?

b) $\frac{6}{1}$?

c) $\frac{1}{1}$?

Jan 2012 Q6

The following shows the results of a survey on the types of exercise taken by a group of 100 people.

65 run 48 swim
60 cycle 40 run and swim
30 swim and cycle 35 run and cycle 25 do all three

(*a*) Draw a Venn Diagram to represent these data. **(4)**

Find the probability that a randomly selected person from the survey

(*b*) takes none of these types of exercise, **(2)**

(*c*) swims but does not run, **(2)**

(d) takes at least two of these types of exercise. **(2)**

Jason is one of the above group. Given that Jason runs,

(*e*) find the probability that he swims but does not cycle. **(3)**

(a) ?

(b) ?

(c) ?

(d) ?

5 A patient going in to a doctor's waiting room reads *Hiya* magazine with probability 0.6 and *Dakor* magazine with probability 0.4. The probability that the patient reads either one or both of the magazines is 0.7. Find the probability that the patient reads:

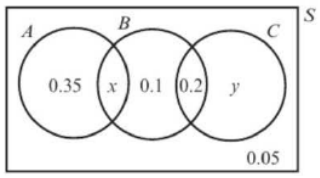
a both magazines **(2 marks)**

b *Hiya* magazine only. **(2 marks)**

a?

b?

6 The Venn diagram shows the probabilities of members of a sports club taking part in various activities.



A represents the event that the member takes part in archery.

B represents the event that the member takes part in badminton.

C represents the event that the member takes part in croquet.

Given that P(*B*) = 0.45:

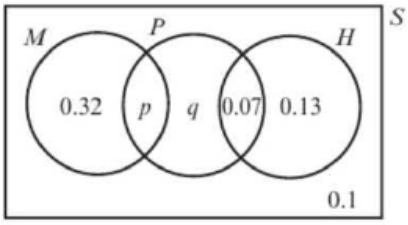
a find x **(1 mark)**

b find y. **(2 marks)**

a?

b?

7 The Venn diagram shows the probabilities that students at a sixth-form college study certain subjects.



M represents the event that the student studies mathematics.

P represents the event that the student studies physics.

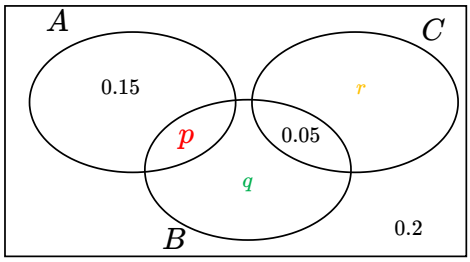
H represents the event that the student studies history.

Given that P(*M*) = P(*P*), find the values of p and q. **(4 marks)**

?

[Challenge p75] The Venn Diagram shows the probabilities of a group of children liking three types of sweet.

Given that $\mathrm{P}(B) = 2\mathrm{P}(A)$ and that $\mathrm{P}(notC) = 0.83$, find the values of p, q, and r.



?

Mutually Exclusive Events 18

- If two events are mutually exclusive **they** ?
- If A and B are mutually exclusive then:
  - $\mathbf{P(AandB) = 0}$?
    ?
    $\mathbf{= P(A) + P(B)}$
- The Venn Diagram would look like:

?

Independent Events 19

- If two events are independent

?

- If A and B are independent then:
  - $\mathbf{P\,(AandB) = P}$?

Note: Independence does not affect how the circles interact in a Venn Diagram.

Example $\quad 1 \quad 2 \quad 3 \quad 4$

1 I pick one of the four numbers 1, 2, 3, 4 at random. What's the probability that:

a) I pick a multiple of 2**:** ?

b) I pick a multiple of 4: ?

2 Explain (conceptually) why these two events are not independent.

?

3 **of the other happening.**

?

Further Examples 20

[Textbook] Events A and B are mutually exclusive and $P\,(A) = 0.2$ and $P\,(B) = 0.4$.

a) Find $P(AorB)$

b) Find $P(AbutnotB)$

c) Find $P(neitherAnorB)$

P ?
P
P

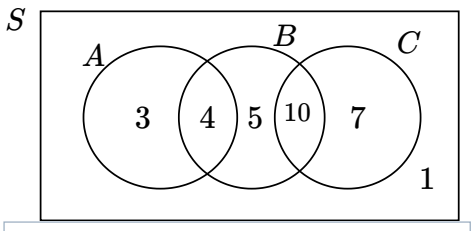
[Textbook] Events A and B are independent and $P\,(A) = \frac{1}{3}$ and $P\,(B) = \frac{1}{5}$. Find $P(AandB)$.

?

[Textbook] The Venn diagram shows the number of students in a particular class who watch any of three popular TV programmes.

a) Find the probability that a student chosen at random watches B or C or both.

b) Determine whether watching A and watching B are statistically independent.



?

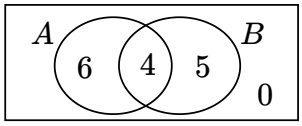
There are three events A, B, C. The events A and B are mutually exclusive.

a) Draw a Venn diagram which represents this information.

b) If $P(A) = 0.1$ and $P(B) = 0.6$, determine $P(neither\ A\ nor\ B)$

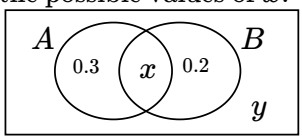
?

The Venn diagram shows the number of people who like each of two different colours. Determine if A and B are independent.



?

The Venn diagram shows the probability of each event. Given that A and B are independent, determine the possible values of x.

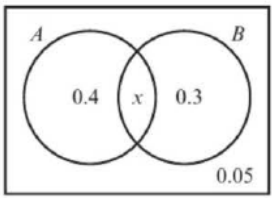


?

6 The Venn diagram shows the probabilities that a group of students like pasta (A) or pizza (B).

a Write down the value of x. **(1 mark)**

b Determine whether the events 'like pasta' and 'like pizza' are independent. **(3 marks)**



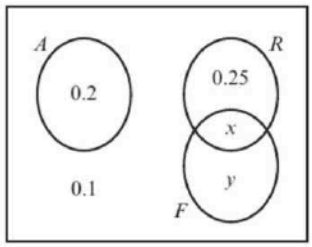
a?

b?

8 W and X are two events such that P(W) = 0.5, P(W and not X) = 0.25 and P(neither W nor X) = 0.3. State, with a reason, whether W and X are independent events. **(3 marks)**

?

9 The Venn diagram shows the probabilities of members of a social club taking part in charitable activities.



A represents taking part in an archery competition.

R represents taking part in a raffle.

F represents taking part in a fun run.

The probability that a member takes part in the archery competition or the raffle is 0.6.

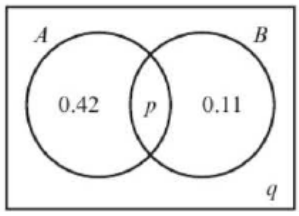
a Find the value of x and the value of y. **(2 marks)**

b Show that events R and F are not independent. **(3 marks)**

a?

b?

10 Given that A and B are independent, find the two possible values for p and q.



?

[Challenge p78] A and B are independent events in a sample space S. Given that A and B are independent, prove that:

a. A and *'not B'* are independent

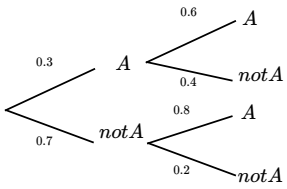
b. '*not* A' and '*not* B' are independent.

a?

b?

At GCSE we saw that tree diagrams were an effective way of showing the outcome of two events which happen **in succession**.

(Personal opinion however is that their use is easily avoidable)



There are 3 yellow and 2 green counters in a bag. I take two counters at random. Determine the probability that:

a) They are of the same colour.

b) They are of different colours.

a ?

b ?

list out the matching sequences of outcomes first, then find the probability for each.

The probability I hit a target on each shot is 0.3. I keep firing until I hit the target. Determine the probability I hit the target on the 5th shot.

?

4 Mr Dixon plays golf. The probability that he scores par or under on the first hole is 0.7. If he scores par or under on the first hole, the probability he scores par or under on the second hole is 0.8. If he doesn't score par or under on the first hole, the probability that he scores par or under on the second hole is 0.4.

a Draw a tree diagram to represent this information. **(3 marks)**

b State whether the events 'scores par or under on the first hole' and 'scores par or under par on the second hole' are independent. **(1 mark)**

c Find the probability that Mr Dixon scores par or under on only one hole. **(3 marks)**

a?

b?

c?

5 A biased coin is tossed three times and it is recorded whether it falls heads or tails.
P(heads) = $\frac{1}{3}$

a Draw a tree diagram to represent this experiment. **(3 marks)**

b Find the probability that the coin lands on heads all three times. **(1 mark)**

c Find the probability that the coin lands on heads only once. **(2 marks)**

The whole experiment is repeated for a second trial.

d Find the probability of obtaining either 3 heads or 3 tails in both trials. **(3 marks)**

a?

b?

c?

d?

6 A bag contains 13 tokens, 4 coloured blue, 3 coloured red and 6 coloured yellow. Two tokens are drawn from the bag without replacement.

a Find the probability that both tokens are yellow. **(2 marks)**

A third token is drawn from the bag.

b Write down the probability that the third token is yellow, given that the first two are yellow. **(1 mark)**

c Find the probability that all three tokens are different colours. **(4 marks)**

a?

b?

c?

1 [STEP I 2009 Q12] Prove that, for any real numbers x and y, $x^2 + y^2 \geq 2xy$.

(i) Carol has two bags of sweets. The first bag contains a red sweets and b blue sweets, whereas the second bag contains b red sweets and a blue sweets. Carol shakes the bags and picks one sweet from each bag without looking. Prove that the probability that the sweets are of the same colour cannot exceed the probability that they are of different colours.

(ii) Simon has three bags of sweets. The first bag contains a red sweet, b white sweets and c yellow sweets. The second bag contains b red sweets, c white sweets and a yellow sweets. The third bag contains c red sweets, a white sweets and b yellow sweets. Simon shakes the bags and picks one sweet from each bag without looking. Show that the probability that exactly two of the sweets are of the same colour is $\frac{3\left(a^2b+b^2c+c^2a+ab^2+bc^2+ca^2\right)}{(a+b+c)^3}$ and find the probability that the sweets are all of the same colour. Deduce that the probability that exactly two of the sweets are of the same colour is at least 6 times the probability that the sweets are all of the same colour.

Solutions

2 [STEP I 2011 Q12] I am selling raffle tickets for £1 per ticket. In the queue for tickets, there are m people each with a single £1 coin and n people each with a single £2 coin. Each person in the queue wants to buy a single raffle ticket and each arrangement of people in the queue is equally likely to occur. Initially, I have no coins and a large supply of tickets. I stop selling tickets if I cannot give the required change.

(i) In the case $n = 1$ and , $m \geq 1$, find the probability that I am able to sell one ticket each person in the queue.

(ii) By considering the first people in the queue, show that the probability that I am able to sell one ticket to each person in the queue in the case $n = 2$ and $m \geq 2$ is $\frac{m-1}{m+1}$

(iii) Show that the probability that I am able to sell one ticket to each person in the queue in the case $n = 3$ and $m \geq 3$ is $\frac{m-2}{m+1}$.

Solutions

3 I have an unfair coin with a fixed probability p of heads. Determine how the unfair coin could be used to simulate a fair coin, i.e. you declare "Heads" or "Tails" each with probability 0.5.

Throw the coin twice. Then the probability of each sequence:

?